BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

When your checks happen

Cycle examples assume no delays and count from the first dose of this schedule. If switching route or continuing previous HER2 treatment, preserve the existing echo due date. Tests are scheduled by elapsed time and clinical need; the team owns booking and result review. NCCP remains 12-weekly during treatment, including maintenance; a longer interval needs an explicit individual specialist plan.

Check	Before first dose	Early visits	Week 6 · around C3	Week 12 · around C5	Later / after stopping
Heart pumping test · echo / MUGA	Baseline before starting	Earlier if symptoms or cardiac concern	Not routinely repeated just because week 6 arrives	Repeat at 12 weeks; earlier checks may be needed	Every 12 weeks during treatment; after stopping, the EMA cardiac follow-up schedule is every 6 months until 24 months. Individual cardiac risk may require more.
Blood tests	Baseline FBC, renal and liver profile	Additional tests if needed	Repeat before this cycle	Repeat before this cycle	Every 6 weeks
ECG / rhythm	Baseline ECG in EMA cardiac assessment; it does not replace echo.	Symptoms or clinical indication	Clinical plan	Clinical plan	Do not substitute ECG for LVEF monitoring
Cancer scans / markers	Document the disease sites and imaging purpose	Assess symptoms at visits	Scan only if due / indicated	Metastatic: often near a response review; exact date agreed	Response scans commonly every 2–4 months; individualise. Markers supplement clinical review and imaging.
DEXA / bone health	If endocrine / ovarian suppression is planned: assess need	Not a routine trastuzumab test alone	Timing depends on risk / result	Separate from the echo schedule	DEXA and repeat timing depend on endocrine treatment, fracture risk and results.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00272 v4 · official regimen · ESC 2022 cardio-oncology guideline · cardiac surveillance and risk · NICE NG101 · bone health and follow-up · ESMO metastatic breast cancer guideline · response assessment · ASCO · biomarkers in metastatic breast cancer · EMA Herceptin product information · retrieved 25 October 2026

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Trastuzumab SC · metastatic: treatment and checks

HER2-positive metastatic breast cancer · SC component

Trastuzumab 600 mg under the skin every 21 days, without a loading dose, while beneficial and tolerated. Any taxane or endocrine partner follows a separate prescription and monitoring plan.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before treatment	First cycles	Around 12 weeks	Continuing treatment	Completion / change
Cancer medicine NCCP 00272	Confirm setting, prior doses and formulation	SC trastuzumab every 3 weeks	Review benefit, symptoms and heart function	Continue while beneficial and tolerated	Review benefit, toxicity and goals; continue or change treatment without a fixed one-year end date.
Surgery METASTATIC	Local procedures only if indicated	No automatic curative surgical sequence	Coordinate procedures with oncology	Symptom / site-specific decisions	Local follow-up as indicated
Radiotherapy EARLY · METASTATIC	Assess indication and planned site	Timing depends on the clinical need	Agree any hold / continuation with radiation oncology	RT is site / symptom directed. Agree any treatment hold with both teams.	Radiation effects and surveillance follow the local plan
Blood tests NCCP 00272	Baseline FBC, renal, liver	Every 6 weeks	Week 12 is another six-week blood-check point for trastuzumab alone; companion therapy may require more frequent tests.	Every 6 weeks	Follow abnormalities and the next treatment plan
Heart checks NCCP 00272 · SMPC	Baseline echo / MUGA; cardiac assessment	Symptoms can trigger earlier checks	Echo / MUGA every 12 weeks; around C5 for uninterrupted 21-day cycles	Repeat every 12 weeks; 4–8 weeks may be needed with impairment	Trastuzumab: six-monthly cardiac checks to 24 months after stopping; see follow-up detail.
Scans / markers EARLY · METASTATIC · MARKERS	Record baseline metastatic sites and scan purpose	Review symptoms at every visit	Response imaging according to the individual disease plan	Usually reassess about every 2–4 months; individualise	Use imaging and clinical assessment together; tumour markers are supplementary.
Endocrine / bone health EARLY · BONE	Check hormone receptor status and endocrine indication	Endocrine timing coordinated with the wider plan	DEXA if indicated by endocrine / fracture risk	May overlap trastuzumab when clinically appropriate	Longer endocrine and bone follow-up can outlast HER2 treatment

What each check is for

1 Blood tests

FBC, renal and liver profile every 6 weeks (around C3, C5, C7 if on time)

Results help determine whether treatment can proceed.

Ask / act: The team confirms booking, results and next dose.

Sources: NCCP 00272

2 Echo / MUGA

Echo / MUGA every 12 weeks; around C5 for uninterrupted 21-day cycles

Heart function can change without symptoms.

Ask / act: Keep the booked scan; report symptoms between scans.

Sources: NCCP 00272 · SMPC

3 Cancer imaging and markers

Response imaging commonly every 2–4 months, adapted to sites, disease course and treatment. A new symptom can need earlier imaging. Tumour markers may supplement assessment, never determine a treatment change alone.

Use the result for a specific clinical decision.

Ask / act: Ask which scan is planned and who reviews it.

Sources: EARLY · METASTATIC · MARKERS

4 Booking and result ownership

At initiation, each review and handover

A recommended test can be missed without a named owner.

Ask / act: Record booking owner, result reviewer, due window and escalation route.

Sources: NCCP 00272

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-10-25 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.21